

Mark Smalley

Chief Technology Officer · Blockchain Protocol Architect · Engineering Leader

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BloomFi Labs

Re: Chief Executive Officer

I am writing to express my interest in the Chief Executive Officer role at BloomFi Labs. I have spent 15 years building, funding, and scaling financial technology businesses that bridge traditional finance and digital assets, operating as a founder-CEO for the majority of that period.

Specific evidence mapped to your requirements:

- ▶ **Senior-level fintech or financial services experience with digital banking, payments, crypto, or embedded finance:** CEO of R1 (2012–2025), Malaysia's leading blockchain infrastructure firm. CTO of Neuroware (500 Startups Batch 9), building compliance-grade tooling for licensed FinTech operators. Head of Engineering at CakeDefi, a 170-engineer crypto-finance company. Production systems delivered across KYC, AML, digital custody, wallet infrastructure, and payments.
- ▶ **Proven track record scaling financial technology businesses:** Personally built the prototype at CakeDefi that became the company's fifth business vertical (Ordzaar), which spun out, raised US\$500K, and was acquired. Co-founded and funded CoKeeps, now Malaysia's largest Digital Asset Custodian by AUM. Sustained Neuroware for 12 years on a US\$300K seed through disciplined capital allocation.
- ▶ **Strong commercial and strategic acumen with investor relations experience:** Led the technical pivot at Oviato that secured DraperVC investment. Accepted into 500 Startups Batch 9 (ranked Top 5 by VentureBeat). First blockchain company admitted to the Securities Commission Malaysia regulatory sandbox. TEDx speaker and public-facing industry leader (Digerati50, conference circuit across Asia).
- ▶ **Cross-functional team management and operational leadership:** Grew CakeDefi's Moonshot team from 1 to 10 engineers in 7 months with full hiring, sprint cadence, and stakeholder reporting ownership. Operated as sole CEO of R1 for 13 years across product delivery, compliance, investor relations, and business development simultaneously. Enterprise client relationships with DBS Bank and Baker Hostetler.
- ▶ **Understanding of regulatory and competitive landscapes in digital assets:** Contributed directly to Malaysia's national Digital Asset regulatory roadmap alongside the Securities Commission and central bank. Named in Deloitte's Top 50 Global RegTech Companies. Deep understanding of compliance requirements across multiple jurisdictions (UK, Malaysia, Singapore, USA).

My career has consistently sat at the intersection this role demands: building the technology that powers digital asset platforms while simultaneously navigating the regulatory, commercial, and fundraising challenges of scaling those businesses. I have operated as both CEO and CTO across multiple ventures, giving me the ability to lead strategic direction and investor conversations while retaining the technical depth to challenge architecture decisions and assess build-versus-buy trade-offs at the infrastructure level. I am currently applying AI-augmented engineering methodology to ship framework-level architecture at solo-founder velocity (Moddable Limited), demonstrating how modern tooling can deliver enterprise-grade output without enterprise-sized teams. This is directly relevant to an early-stage fintech seeking to move quickly with lean resources.

I am UK-based, immediately available, and comfortable operating in a self-employed consulting capacity. I hold British citizenship and have extensive experience working across time zones with distributed teams (15 years across UK, Malaysia, Singapore, and the US). I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building and leading fintech businesses from zero to scale can contribute to BloomFi Labs' ambitions.

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